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Maternal & Child Health Division · National Health Mission (NHM)

NATIONAL GUIDELINES FOR POSTNATAL CARE (PNC)

Domiciliary Surveillance & Maternal-Infant Recovery Guidelines

DOCUMENT ID: R4-NHM-2026 **EDITION:** Official Field Standard 4.2 **TARGET:** Frontline ASHA Workers

1. Mandatory Domiciliary PNC Visit Timelines

• Home Delivery Visits: Day 1, Day 3, Day 7, Day 14, Day 21, Day 28, Day 42.

• Institutional Delivery Visits: Day 3, Day 7, Day 14, Day 21, Day 28, Day 42 (Day 1 covered at facility).

• Low Birth Weight / Preterm infants receive additional home visits on Day 35 and Day 42.

2. Maternal Assessment Checklist

• Measure blood pressure and temperature at each visit (watch for puerperal sepsis or late postpartum pre-eclampsia).

• Examine lochia: check volume, color, and odor (foul smell indicates uterine infection).

• Inspect perineum / episiotomy or caesarean scar for induration, redness, or purulent discharge.

• Counsel on exclusive breastfeeding (EBF), postpartum contraception, and mental health / postpartum depression.

3. Postnatal Nutrition & Micronutrient Protocol

• Continue 1 tablet IFA daily for 180 days postpartum to replenish maternal iron stores.

• Maternal calcium supplementation (1000mg daily) throughout the lactation period.

Issuing Authority:
National Health Mission Division
Nirman Bhawan, New Delhi

Field Protocol Verification:
Primary Health Centre / Block MO
Mandatory compliance across sub-centres

ASHA Frontline Desk:
Document all actions in MCP Card
Follow 108 Emergency Protocol